

Aviv Gelfand

📍 Jerusalem, Israel

✉ avivgelfand@gmail.com

☎ 054-300-7257

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🌐 AvivGelfand

Summary

- Hands-on Applied Data Scientist with a proven record of building and deploying real-world AI and NLP solutions in startup, academic, and military settings.
- Skilled in LLMs, prompt engineering, and production ML pipelines. Passionate about using data science to drive impactful, user-centered applications.
- MSc candidate in Data Science (Hebrew University, LLM-focused thesis), on a flexible schedule, structured to prioritize a full-time role at a DS/ML/AI team.

Experience

Data Scientist

2024 – present

Darrow AI - Data Science Team

- Designed and deployed an A-Z production pipeline that uncovered a \$1M+ needle in large medical data sets. Leveraged few-shot Chain-of-Thought LLM prompting, optimised costs with OpenAI's Batch API, enriched and filtered leads databases with domain-specific intelligence, integrating multi-source web scraping.
- Performed numerous model evaluations and error analyses querying large-scale text datasets, collaborating with senior DSs, DEs, PMs, and other stakeholders.
- Worked with AWS environment, Airflow, Atlassian (JIRA). Built pipelines querying across model endpoints, S3 data lakes, Elastic / OpenSearch, and PostgreSQL databases.

NLP Data Scientist & Research Assistant

2023 – 2024

Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Adi Leibovitch's Quantitative Legal Research lab

- Executed Supervised-Fine-Tuning of open-source LLMs to classify textual argument-types in trials; reduced labeling time and errors, replacing manual tagging with LLM-based tagging. Applied PEFT and LoRA with HF, PyTorch, and CUDA.
- Achieved over 90% accuracy and 80% F1 scores in most target labels. Saved days of model complexity and training time using efficient sampling, overcoming significant imbalance.
- Presented findings and achievements at a prominent statistics and data science conference in May 2024.

Statistics & Machine Learning Instructor

2022 – 2024

Upscale Analytics

- Built dozens of hands-on ML projects as assignments for a practical course in statistical inference and classic ML, with constant feedback from a Senior Data Scientist (and head lecturer), Michael Winer.
- Advanced from teaching assistant to instructor, then to a full rights partner after 3 successful semesters of weekly TA sessions with a significant presence of students. Worked primarily with Scikit-Learn, SciPy, and XGBoost Libraries.

Programmer & Research Assistant

2022 – 2023

Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Renana Peres's Computational Social Science Lab

- Self-taught and programmed smart contracts with a C++-based programming language. Developed a simulation interface (React.js). Designed and analyzed experiments, web-scraped data monthly, and did literature and academic peer reviews.

Data Analyst & Research Team Leader

2015 – 2020

Israel Defense Forces (Volunteered, Lieutenant)

- Conducted research, threat assessments, and analysis for high-ranked decision-makers and enhanced output capacity.
- Led cross-org initiatives, yielding in-depth research papers via unprecedented cooperations with research branches.

Education

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2024 – 2027

MSc in Data Science — LLMs-focused Thesis.

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2021 – 2024

BSc in Statistics & Data Science (GPA 89)

Skills and Technologies

Scripting Languages and Tools: Python, Java, Solidity (C++ based), R, SQL, JS;

GenAI Tools: Prompt Engineering (CoT, Few-Shot, eg.), structured outputs, HuggingFace Transformers (SFT, PEFT)

EDA & ETL: Pandas, NumPy; DataBricks, AWS OpenSearch, and RDS (PostgreSQL); Cleaning, encoding, and embedding pipelines

ML & Stats: SKLearn, PyTorch; feature engineering, statistical analysis, evaluations & error analysis, efficient sampling

CI/CD & Other: AWS (ECS, SSM, Parameter Store, S3), Apache Aiflow, DataDog (logs), Shell scripts, GitHub & GitLab